

DRISHTEE VIDUSHI FELLOWSHIP

Interview Preparation Guide — Ramesh Chandra Soren (CSE, IIST Shibpur)

Interview Platform	Naad 2.0 (Voice-based AI Interview)
Interview Type	Vidushi
Format	Warm-up (3 recordings) + 6 Questions
Duration	~6–8 minutes
Deadline	17th April 2026, 11:59 PM
Link	https://www.nuren.ai/public-interview

1. ABOUT DRISHTEE — Know This Cold

What is Drishtee?: A social enterprise enabling rural micro-enterprise development, supply chain linkages, skill development, investment, and banking services across rural India. Founded in 2000.

Scale: Operates across 7,000+ villages in India. Annual revenue: \$4 million+. Presence in USA and Japan too.

Core Framework: Swavlamban (Self-Reliance) — empowering rural communities toward shared prosperity.

Mission: Develop 10 million livelihoods in 10 years through community organisations (Vatika), ecosystem support, and sustainable business services.

4C Approach: Community (understand needs, build synergy) | Capacity (skill building) | Capital (fund rural ventures) | Channels (market linkages, supply chain)

Key Partners: NSDC, Godrej, Nestlé, IBM, Genpact, State Bank of India, Bank of Baroda, Acumen Fund, Ashoka, Clinton Global Initiative, UNESCO, MetLife, Novartis, Shell Foundation and many more.

Awards: World Bank Development Marketplace Award (2003), Schwab Foundation Social Entrepreneur of the Year (2005), World Economic Forum Technology Pioneer (2007), Great Place to Work (2023).

Swavlamban Model (Key Terms to Know)

Term	Meaning
Vatika	Community cluster/village group
Rural Swavalamban Samiti (SWSM)	Village-level self-help community group
Vidushi	Gram-level field worker who identifies and selects village members
Mitra	Community mobilizer
Vaibhavi (MEG)	Micro Enterprise Group — women-led production units
Udyogi Parivar	Producer households
Vasuki	Urban liaison/connector
Dhavak	Delivery network connecting rural producers to urban markets
Miri Haat / Miri Retail / Miri Circle	Drishtee's market channels (rural & urban)

Vaani	Multi-skill training centre
CBS	Community-Based System — reporting mechanism

2. THE VIDUSHI FELLOW ROLE

What you'll do:

- Build and support rural start-ups and micro-enterprises (MEGs) across 10 value chains in one block.
- Scale rural businesses through market access and operational support.
- Product development, quality improvement, and packaging for rural products.
- Strengthen rural supply chains — connect producers to markets.
- Create impact stories and document successful business cases.
- Build rural networks across supply chain and banking ecosystems.
- Mobilise local and urban volunteers for enterprise support activities.
- Enable rural entrepreneurs to develop market-ready products and services.
- Support the Village Advisory Group (VAG) and report through CBS (Happiness Café).

Your KRAs (Key Result Areas):

KRA 1: Capacity building of Micro Enterprise Groups across 10 value chains within one block.

KRA 2: Strengthen Village Advisory Group to support MEGs in quality, efficiency, packaging, marketing, input support, and market linkages.

KRA 3: Support MEGs in developing at least one Specialised Micro Enterprise Group (in one value chain).

KRA 4: Enable Producers to connect with MEGs — with a special focus on inclusion of the 4th quartile (most marginalised).

KRA 5: Mobilise local & urban volunteers through VAG; drive participation in Happiness Café-led reporting via CBS.

CTC	■5,40,000 per annum (including travel reimbursement)
Duration	6 months Fellowship → Full-time absorption based on performance
Location	Assigned territory at district/block level
Domains	CSE/IT, Mechanical Engg, Agri Engg, Finance, Rural Marketing, Architecture, Mass Comm, Food Pro

3. LIKELY INTERVIEW QUESTIONS & MODEL ANSWERS

The Vidushi interview has 6 questions + warm-up. Based on Drishtee's profile and the role, expect these types:

Q1 (Warm-up): Tell me about yourself.

Keep it to 60 seconds. Structure: Who you are → Your background → Why social impact → Why Drishtee.

Sample: "I'm Ramesh Chandra Soren, a final-year CSE student at IEST Shibpur. I've interned at organisations like Spacey Science in London and built tech systems used by 1000+ users. I'm deeply

passionate about using technology and entrepreneurship to create grassroots impact. Drishtee's Swavlamban model — especially connecting rural producers to markets through technology and community networks — is exactly where I want to contribute."

Q2: Why do you want to join Drishtee / this fellowship?

Be specific about Drishtee, not generic. Mention: Swavlamban model, rural micro-enterprise development, their 4C approach, and how your background (CSE/tech/entrepreneurship projects) will add value to digital tools, supply chain data, or impact storytelling.

Sample: "Drishtee's approach goes beyond typical NGO work — it builds actual businesses. The idea of helping a Vaibhavi MEG scale from a village production unit to selling via Miri Retail or urban markets excites me. With my background in full-stack development and data systems, I can help MEGs with digital record-keeping, quality tracking, and market analysis."

Q3: What do you know about rural entrepreneurship / the challenges rural entrepreneurs face?

Key points to mention:

- Lack of market access and price discovery
- Limited capital and no formal credit history
- Poor quality control and packaging
- Supply chain gaps between producer and consumer
- Digital/financial exclusion
- Drishtee's answer: MEGs + Dhavak + Banking CSPs + Vaani skill training

Q4: How would your technical/engineering background help in a rural development role?

This is your bridge question. Sample answer:

- "My experience building ERP backends and APIs means I can help MEGs track inventory, orders, and revenue digitally."
- "I can help build simple dashboards or WhatsApp-based tools for reporting (CBS)."
- "My data analysis skills can identify which value chains have the most market potential."
- "During my TradeStream Engine project, I learned to work under real constraints — similar to field conditions."

Q5: What are your thoughts on working in a rural/field environment at district/block level?

Be honest but positive. Emphasise:

- Comfort with field work, adaptability, and ground-level problem solving
- Mention any rural exposure you have (background from Jharkhand, Kendriya Vidyalaya in Asansol — semi-urban context)
- Show understanding that real impact happens on the ground, not in offices
- Acknowledge the Swavlamban model's philosophy of Swavlamban — self-reliance built through sustained presence

Q6: Where do you see yourself in 2–3 years? / What are your career goals?

Align with Drishtee's growth path: Vidushi Fellow → Cluster/State Team → Vertical Team → Possibly new geography launches.

Sample: "I see myself growing within Drishtee into a Cluster or Vertical Team role, possibly contributing to the technology vertical — building digital tools that help scale the Swavlamban model to new geographies. Long-term, I want to work at the intersection of technology and rural enterprise development."

Possible Q7: What is the 4C approach? Can you explain it?

Community: Understand needs, inspire & create joint ownership.

Capacity: Build or enhance skills relevant to available opportunities.

Capital: Organise funds needed for entrepreneurial ventures.

Channels: Create both backward (input) and forward (market) linkages.

Possible Q8: What is one idea you would implement as a Vidushi Fellow?

Example answer: "I would create a simple WhatsApp-based daily reporting system for MEG members to log production output and quality checks. This would feed into the CBS reporting mechanism and help Village Advisory Group members monitor progress without needing smartphones or internet — using voice notes and basic image uploads. This makes data collection grassroots-native and reduces reporting friction."

4. VOICE INTERVIEW TIPS (NAAD 2.0)

Before you start

- ✓ Find a quiet room — no fan noise, no traffic sounds if possible.
- ✓ Test your microphone. Speak clearly, at a moderate pace.
- ✓ Keep these notes open beside you — it's an AI interview, no one is watching.
- ✓ Have a glass of water. Nerves dry your throat.
- ✓ Select 'Vidushi' from the interview type dropdown.

During the interview

- ✓ Speak at 70% of your normal speed — AI transcription needs clarity.
- ✓ Pause briefly before each answer (2-3 seconds) to collect your thoughts.
- ✓ Use Drishtee's own vocabulary: Vaibhavi, MEG, Vatika, Swavlamban, CBS — shows you did your homework.
- ✓ Each answer: 45–75 seconds is ideal. Not too short, not too long.
- ✓ Structure every answer: Point → Reason → Example (PRE method).
- ✓ End your answer with a clear conclusion sentence so the AI knows you're done.

Language

- ✓ English is fine. Speak confidently — your accent doesn't matter, clarity does.
- ✓ Avoid 'umm', 'like', 'you know' — pause silently instead.
- ✓ Mention specific terms from Drishtee's documents to show genuine preparation.

5. YOUR STRENGTHS TO HIGHLIGHT

As a CSE student applying for a social enterprise fellowship, position yourself as a 'tech-enabled changemaker':

- **Progress Tracker (Spacey Science):** Led development of a module serving 500+ users — directly translates to building tracking tools for MEGs and CBS reporting.
- **ERP System (IIST Shibpur):** Built backend for 1000+ user onboarding — experience relevant to managing rural enterprise data systems.
- **Chess Master App / TradeStream Engine:** Shows ability to build complex, user-facing systems under constraints — analogous to rural tech deployment challenges.
- **LeetCode Knight + Hackathon (Rank 335/2095):** Problem-solving mindset — critical for field-level challenges with no textbook solutions.
- **IIST Shibpur + West Bengal background:** Geographic familiarity with West Bengal (Drishtee operates in 8 districts there) — can communicate locally.

6. QUICK REFERENCE: KEY NUMBERS & FACTS

7,000+	Villages Drishtee operates in
\$4M+	Annual revenue
10 million	Target livelihoods in 10 years
10 value chains	MEGs to be built per block (your KRA)
4th quartile	Most marginalised producers — special inclusion focus
2000	Year Drishtee was founded
11 states	Phase 1 operational states (incl. West Bengal, Bihar, UP, Assam)
■5,40,000	Fellowship CTC per annum
4C	Community, Capacity, Capital, Channels
USA & Japan	International presence of Drishtee

7. PRE-INTERVIEW CHECKLIST

- Read this guide at least once more before the interview
- Memorise: Swavlamban, 4C, Vaibhavi, Vatika, Vidushi, Dhavak, CBS
- Prepare your 'Tell me about yourself' — practice it out loud 3 times
- Set up quiet room, test mic, have water ready
- Visit: <https://www.nuren.ai/public-interview> and select 'Vidushi'
- Complete before: 17th April 2026, 11:59 PM
- Stay calm — it's an AI, not a human panel. No judgment, just transcription.

Good luck, Ramesh! You've got the skills — now show them the impact mindset. ■